

Department of the Air Force: Justification for Other Than Full and Open Competition

Dollar Value of this Acquisition: ☒ ≤ \$10M ☐ > \$10M and ≤ \$100M ☐ > \$100M and ≤ \$500M ☐ > \$500M

CERTIFICATIONS: CO certification serves as J&A approval ≤ \$10M, *See [J&A Template Guidance](https://usaf.dps.mil/sites/AFCC/AQCP/KnowledgeCenter/SitePages/DAF-Contracting-Compass/Part-6---Competition-Requirements.aspx#exceptions-to-full-and-open-competition-mandatory) at <https://usaf.dps.mil/sites/AFCC/AQCP/KnowledgeCenter/SitePages/DAF-Contracting-Compass/Part-6---Competition-Requirements.aspx#exceptions-to-full-and-open-competition-mandatory>* J&A Template Guidance tab

Date 15 April 2026	Contracting Officer (RFO 6.104-1(12)) Richard T. Saltsman AFLCMC/PZITB I certify that this justification is accurate and complete to the best of my knowledge and belief.	Signature 
Date 15 April 2026	Technical and Requirements Personnel (RFO 6.104(b))  I certify that the supporting data herein, which is my responsibility, is accurate and complete.	Signature 

COORDINATION**APPROVALS (RFO 6.104-2(a) Table 6-1 & R-DFARS 206.104-72 Table 206.1)**

See [J&A Template Guidance](https://usaf.dps.mil/sites/AFCC/AQCP/KnowledgeCenter/SitePages/DAF-Contracting-Compass/Part-6---Competition-Requirements.aspx#exceptions-to-full-and-open-competition-mandatory) (<https://usaf.dps.mil/sites/AFCC/AQCP/KnowledgeCenter/SitePages/DAF-Contracting-Compass/Part-6---Competition-Requirements.aspx#exceptions-to-full-and-open-competition-mandatory>) - Justification Approvals tab

NOTE 1: A signature block will appear here (replacing these notes) based on the "Dollar Value of this Acquisition" selected above. Since most digital signatures that include date/time-stamps are redacted before they are made publicly available, always insert the date in the "Date" cell when affixing a digital signature to this document.

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I. Agency and Contracting Activity (RFO 6.104-1(a)(1)):

AFLCMC/PZITB, Information Technology
2275 D Street
Building 16
Wright-Patterson AFB, Ohio 45433

II. Nature and/or description of the action being approved (RFO 6.104-1(a)(2)):

This document approves the award of a contract on a sole source basis to STARLIMS Corporation for their Silver Support and Update Plan (SSUP) for the sustainment of the Air Force Test and Analysis Tool (AFTAT) in support of the [REDACTED]. This justification is made on an Individual basis.

III. Description of supplies/services required to meet agency needs (RFO 6.104-1(a)(3)):

AFTAT is the information management backbone for all [REDACTED] laboratories and is a customized Commercial off-the-shelf (COTS) laboratory management system developed by Abbott Informatics for [REDACTED] laboratory system. SSUP includes rights to software updates, fixes, corrections, workarounds, releases, version, enhancements, HTML Designer License and documentation updates. The SSUP is an annual plan that includes support for software development and reconfiguration as well as labor hours for general technical support and designing software modifications.

Under the contemplated contract, Abbott Informatics will provide their Silver Support and Update Plan (SSUP) including HTML Designer License for the sustainment of the AFTAT and expert support for software development and reconfiguration billed in the amount per day. AFTAT is a customized Commercial off-the-shelf (COTS) laboratory management system developed by Abbott Informatics for [REDACTED] laboratory system. SSUP includes rights to software updates, fixes, corrections, workarounds, releases, version, enhancements, HTML Designer License and documentation updates.

The intent of this purchasing action is to procure five years, base year and four option years, of SSUP at a yearly cost of [REDACTED] for a total contract value of [REDACTED]. 3400 appropriations will fund this effort. The period of performance for the base year is 01 June 2026 through 31 May 2027. The period of performance for the option years are as followed:

Option Year 1: 1 June 2027 through 31 May 2028
Option Year 2: 1 June 2028 through 31 May 2029
Option Year 3: 1 June 2029 through 31 May 2030
Option Year 4: 1 June 2030 through 31 May 2031

The rationale for the multi-year requirement is based on the proprietary nature of the core code. Abbott is a COTS product provided by the Abbott Informatics. The core software code is proprietary to Abbott and cannot be modified by anyone other than Abbott. There is no reasonable feasibility and/or expectation that competition other than Abbott Informatics will be available this year or in future years. For this reason, [REDACTED] believes it is reasonable to seek approval for four option years beyond the base year.

IV. Statutory Authority Permitting Other Than Full and Open Competition (RFO 6.104-1(a)(4)):

10 U.S.C. 3204(a)(1), Only one responsible source and no other supplies or services will satisfy agency requirements.

V. Rationale for Use of Authority (RFO 6.104-1(a)(5)):

AFTAT is a highly specialized COTS software package that integrates all [REDACTED] laboratories as well as remote users located at every Air Force base in the world. AFTAT has the capability to centrally manage samples, associated tests, test methods, and test results; and automate, store, manipulate, manage, move, control, display, interchange, transmit and receive critical

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laboratory testing information. To maintain an approved Authority to Operate (ATO) on Air Force networks, all software systems, including AFTAT, must remain current with network security, certification and accreditation and overall net worthiness. Consequently, AFTAT requires software patches, upgrades, fixes, corrections and workarounds. Although AFTAT is not unique in that it requires continual upgrades, patches, etc., the system itself is based on proprietary core code that can only be changed by Abbott Informatics. [REDACTED] has an active contract with Abbott Informatics to provide the same Abbott SSUP (contract # FA8604-21-CB023, awarded 11 May 2021). The current active contract was awarded as a sole source and expires 31 May 2026. Therefore, this acquisition is for the continued performance of a highly specialized service.

Abbott is a highly specialized laboratory information management system (LIMS) developer with more than 25 years of experience working with hundreds of laboratories in the U.S. Government, State Government, Public Health, environmental, petrochemical, forensic, pharmaceutical, clinical and diagnostic sectors. Abbott award-winning, fully web-based COTS LIMS, is a future-proof technology platform, which is based entirely on the 'Microsoft .NET' framework. Abbott's fully web-based functionality is key because it eliminates the need to install software on client workstations, an extreme advantage in today's Air Force, ever increasing, vigilance for network security.

[REDACTED] believes that the award to any other source would result in substantial duplication of costs to the Government that is not expected to be recovered through competition and unacceptable delays in fulfilling the Air Force's requirements. The initial purchase price for AFTAT from Abbott Corporation was [REDACTED] (Contract NBCHD020088-0071). The initial purchase included the COTS software, customization, seven full site licenses (five permanent laboratories and two deployable laboratories) and hardware. In addition, [REDACTED] invested [REDACTED] for the mandatory Certification and Accreditation of AFTAT for use on Air Force networks (Contract FA8604-09-M-7079). Finally, enhanced functionality and mandated security upgrades (such as common access card (CAC) enabling and in-depth auditing capability) resulted in more than 500K of additional funds invested in AFTAT (Contracts FA8604-09-F-7503, FA8604-10-C-7028, FA8604-12-F-7165, FA8604-12-F-7199, FA8604-12-C-7028, FA8604-16-C-7014, and FA8604-21-CB023). Since the core software code for AFTAT is proprietary to Abbott and cannot be modified by anyone other than Abbott, an award to any other vendor would necessitate the purchase and development of a comparable LIMS system. The total cost to replace AFTAT based on the initial cost to purchase the system plus the cost to obtain a new certification and accreditation, costs of the security upgrades and less the cost of the hardware (assume the hardware could be used for the new system) would be [REDACTED]. The cost for the Abbott SSUP for the proposed purchasing action is [REDACTED]/year for five years or a total of [REDACTED].

Accordingly, Abbott Informatics is the only firm capable of providing the supplies and services described in Section III above without the Air Force experiencing substantial duplication of cost that could not be expected to be recovered through competition.

VI. Integrated Market Analysis and Efforts to Solicit Competition (RFO 6.104-1(a)(6), (8), and (10)):

AFTAT is a proprietary COTS product owned by Abbott Informatics. Abbott is the sole developer, manufacturer, and seller of the software and is the only source that can change the core code. Department of Defense, Air Force and local Base security policies mandate software patches, fixes and compatibility to new operating system software releases (i.e. Windows, Internet Explorer, SQL Server, etc.). Abbott is the only source that can make the required updates and changes.

AFTAT is a COTS system that is proprietary to Abbott Informatics. The primary reason for purchasing the Abbott SSUP is to keep current with version upgrades to client and server operating software. Consequently, all changes to the COTS to ensure compatibility are core code changes. Abbott Informatics is the only source that can modify its core code.

[REDACTED] believes that any source other than Abbott Informatics would result in substantial duplication of costs since an entirely new system would have to be developed, tested, and implemented (see Section V, paragraph 3). To date, no alternate sources are available that would be able to legally modify or be compatible with the proprietary code of Abbott SSUP.

Abbott Informatics is the only known source capable of providing the support described in Section III of this justification without the government experiencing substantial duplication of cost that could not be recovered through competition.

Although there are several known laboratory information management software developers as well as COTS systems

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available, none possesses the legal access to core AFTAT proprietary code. For this reason, Abbott Informatics is the only source considered for this procurement. In the future, to prevent sole source requirements, we will continue to conduct market research to determine alternate sources of support.

VII. Determination of Fair and Reasonable Cost (RFO 6.104-1(a)(7)):

The Contracting Officer is responsible for evaluating, determining, and documenting the anticipated contract cost/price is fair and reasonable in accordance with RFO Subpart 15.4, Contract Pricing.

VIII. Any Other Facts Supporting the Justification (RFO 6.104-1(a)(9)):

Refer to Section III, V, VI and VIII for pertinent data. No other supporting documentation is currently available.

IX. Actions to Overcome Barriers to Competition (RFO 6.104-1(a)(11)):

██████ will ensure that all known laboratory information management developers will be evaluated for all future acquisitions for the support and update services which include the rights to AFTAT software updates, fixes, corrections, workarounds, releases, version, enhancements and documentation to promote fair and equitable competition.